REWARDS RESEARCH · REFERENCE

Shopify rewards program — options & pricing

If Michele wants an off-the-shelf app instead of (or alongside) the custom Epos + Shopify + Zapier build, here's what's actually on the market as of September 2026. All prices are monthly, billed by Shopify order volume/active members — exact tier depends on her store size once she has real traffic.

APP	FREE PLAN	PAID PLANS START AT	NOTES
Smile.io	Yes	$15–$199/mo (Plus tiers from $999/mo)	Most installed loyalty app on Shopify; easiest setup, points + referrals + VIP tiers; good documentation
Rivo	Yes	$49/mo (enterprise $499–$699/mo)	Newer, strong reviews for mid-size stores; points, referrals, subscriptions in one app
LoyaltyLion	Yes	~$159–$399/mo (VIP/Advanced ~$699/mo)	Deep customization, but pricier at the tier Michele would likely need for real VIP tiers
Yotpo Loyalty	Yes	~$199+/mo	Bundles with Yotpo reviews/UGC — worth it only if she also wants reviews
Okendo	Yes	$19/mo and up (bundle pricing)	Loyalty is part of a bundle, not a standalone leader

Recommendation: a boutique this size will outgrow every free tier the moment Michele wants real point-earning + redemption at checkout (not just a badge widget) — that puts her in the $15–$50/mo range realistically (Smile.io "Starter/Growth" or Rivo's $49/mo tier are the most boutique-appropriate). That's $180–$600/year, forever, on top of Shopify's own subscription.

Why the custom route is on the table

Because Epos Now already has a native customer/loyalty-points field, and both Epos and Shopify expose an API, the same behavior — earn points per purchase, redeem for a discount, balance visible to the customer — can be wired with Zapier as the connector instead of a monthly app. Michele pays $0/mo extra once it's built; the cost is Amber's one-time build time instead of a

recurring subscription. See the separate **Custom Rewards Build Guide** for exactly what that takes and how long it runs.

When to recommend the app instead

- If Michele wants tiered VIP status, gamified badges, or a public rewards-page widget out of the box — that's more polish than a from-scratch build should attempt first.
- If she wants it live in days, not weeks — an app installs same-day; the custom build has real engineering hours behind it.
- If the store scales fast and needs a support team behind the loyalty tool — app vendors provide that; a custom build is supported by Amber alone.